- Designs a questionnaire for the collection of data.
- Describes Secondary data
- Explains the advantages of Sampling over Census method
- Describes Probability sampling methods and their appropriateness.
- Explains the uses of Non-Probability sampling
- Differentiates Sampling and Non-sampling errors

Introduction

Statistical data are the basic 'ingredients' of Statistics on which statistician work. A set of numbers representing records of observations is termed statistical data. The need to collect data arises in every sphere of human activity. However that 'Garbage in garbage out' applies in Statistics too. Hence adequate care must be taken in the collection of data. It is a poor practice to depend on whatever data available.

Data collection process:

There are five important questions to ask in the process of collecting data: What? How? Who? Where? When?

QUESTION	RELATED ACTIVITY
What data is to be collected?	Decide the relevant data of the study
How will the data be collected?	Choice of a data collection instrument
Who will collect the data?	Method of enquiry: Primary / Secondary
Where the data will be collected?	Decide the Population oftt the survey
When will the data be collected?	Fixing the time schedule

This unit addresses the above Questions in detail

2.1 Categories and Sources of Data

There are two categories of data namely primary data and secondary data.

Primary data are that information which is collected for the first time, from a Survey, or an observational study or through experimentation. For example

- A survey is conducted to identify the reasons from the parents for selection of a particular school for their children in a locality.
- Information collected from the observations made by the customers based on the service they received.

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